It is well-known that G.D. Birla freely bankrolled Congress activities and 'the Mahatma had a habit of milking the willing cow'.[5] But he knew that Purshotamdas was unwilling to serve as a 'Kamadhenu'[6]. An interesting incident which reflects his reluctance took place at about the same time in London. Gandhi sent C.F. Andrews with a scrap of paper requesting ₹5,000 for Rabindranath Tagore's Shantiniketan. Since it was a non-political cause he felt that Purshotamdas would not refuse. He was right. Purshotamdas gave Andrews the cheque but with it came a friendly warning: 'Don't come for money to me again.'[7] In fact the job given to Andrews was usually done by Mahadev Desai but knowing Purshotamdas's reluctance in such matters, Gandhi sent Andrews instead. He used to tease Mahadev Desai on his inability to extract money from Purshotamdas.[8] 'You are a bad canvasser. You will never succeed with Purshotamdas.'[9]

But Gandhi knew that nothing was closer to Purshotamdas's heart than India's interests. On one occasion Purshotamdas dressed in white muslin was talking to Gandhi when a common friend suggested to Gandhi that he should ask Purshotamdas why he did not wear khaddar. Gandhi answered: 'Why should I? If he opens his heart, he is all national.'[10] On another occasion it required the intervention of Sardar Patel to call off over zealous Congress workers who had posted pickets outside 'Suneeta',[11] Purshotamdas's residence in Malabar Hill. Purshotamdas had refused at the height of the boycott movement to prevent European business houses from trading in cotton on the exchange despite repeated entreaties from Congress volunteers. The Sardar was in Yervada jail when news of the pickets reached him. He was greatly upset saying that Purshotamdas was 'more our man than anyone else's.'[12] When Purshotamdas thanked the Sardar for his help he said, 'They should never have acted like that.'[13]

Purshotamdas's activities were by no means confined to the Federal Structure Sub-committee. He was busy with informal discussions on a host of economic and political issues and sat in with Gandhi with the representatives of European commerce in India who were canvassing support for financial safeguards to preserve their trading rights. The most important matter which engaged Purshotamdas's attention at this time was the financial impact on India as a result of Britain going off the gold standard. Britain went off the gold standard on September 21, 1931, and two contradictory statements were made on behalf of the government. The